MONTHLY UPDATE

Somalia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · DATA

Governance

Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

Legislation and regulation

DRAFT PENAL CODE REPLACING THE 1962 CODE

- **Somalia Penal Code Reform Targets Cybercrime and Emerging Digital Offences** — Goobjoog English, 14 October 2026

  Somalia's parliament is reviewing a draft Penal Code to replace the 1962 code, adding provisions for offences involving digital platforms and information systems. The Speaker of the House of the People discussed it with the judiciary committee and the justice minister. No timetable for a final vote has been announced.

Regional collaboration

PEER-LEARNING COOPERATION WITH PAKISTAN ON DIGITAL IDENTITY AND PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Somalia and Pakistan deepen cooperation on digital identity and public infrastructure** — UNDP Pakistan, 16 September 2026

  A Somali delegation led by the director-general of the National Identification and Registration Authority, Abdiwali Ali Abdulle, ended a ten-day UNDP-convened mission to Pakistan on 16 September 2026. It studied Pakistan's identity authority, data-exchange layer, social registry and Raast instant payments, and validated a joint action matrix on digital identity and public infrastructure.

- **Peer Learning to Collaboration: Somalia & Pakistan Deepen Partnership on Digital Infrastructure** — Somali Stream, 19 September 2026

  A 15-member Somali delegation completed a ten-day peer-learning programme on digital identity and public infrastructure in Islamabad and Lahore, designed by UNDP and the two countries' identity authorities. A Somali official said the national identity authority registers only about 2,000 people a day, far below capacity, and that Somalia has no national data exchange layer.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

STATE TAKEDOWN OF SOCIAL MEDIA PAGES

- **Somali government closes 82,000 extremist-linked social media pages in 2026** — Hiiraan Online, 4 September 2026

> Somalia's federal government has shut 82,000 social media pages in 2026 that it says armed groups used for extremist propaganda, Ministry of Information director general Abdullahi Hayir Duale said in Mogadishu on 3 September 2026. He named Facebook, TikTok and Telegram among the platforms and said closures will continue. No figures on appeals or oversight are given.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Connectivity

BERBERA INTERNATIONAL GATEWAY ROUTE

- **Somaliland fibre route tests Kenya's regional digital edge** — Business Daily, 15 September 2026 KENYA ETHIOPIA SOUTH SUDAN

  Berbera is being positioned as an alternative digital gateway for landlocked Ethiopia and South Sudan, offering providers, businesses and governments another route to global data connections beside the established Mombasa gateway.

NATIONAL INTERCONNECTION BETWEEN OPERATORS

- **Somalia's mobile money remains locked in silos** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026

  The chief executive of Somalia's SomLink Telecom says voice calls now interconnect across six operators while mobile-money wallets remain closed to one another. He calls for cost-based pricing and shared rails, and says the largest operators have little commercial reason to open up.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS · Registries · Sectoral management information systems

Digital Identity and CRVS

PROPOSED NATIONAL ID REQUIREMENT FOR SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNTS

- **The Ministry of Information Wants a Name Behind Every Somali Account** — The Somali Digest, 9 September 2026

  Somalia's deputy prime minister, Jibril Abdirashid Abdi, asked the information ministry on 7 September 2026 to require social media accounts to carry the holder's NIRA identity number in the media regulations being drafted. He spoke at a communication forum in Mogadishu; the report also records dozens of disputed takedowns of Puntland broadcasters' posts between January and August.

- **Opinion: My Reflections on the Strategic and Communication Forum 2026** — Dawan Africa, 11 September 2026

  An opinion piece on Somalia's Strategic and Communication Forum 2026 in Mogadishu, organised by the information ministry, notes that Deputy Prime Minister Jibril Abdi Rashid Haji Abdi proposed requiring NIRA national identification to open accounts, citing security and misinformation. The author calls for the proposal to be weighed against privacy and free expression, and for a mechanism to follow up the forum's recommendations.

BIOMETRIC PASSPORT AND TRAVEL-DATA EXCHANGE

- **Somali immigration agency, AU discuss border security and counterterrorism cooperation** — Hiiraan Online, 16 September 2026

Somalia's Immigration and Citizenship Agency met the African Union Counter Terrorism Centre in Mogadishu on 16 September 2026 to discuss border security and the exchange of security and travel information. The agency briefed the delegation on its digital systems for migration data and document verification, including biometric passports and an e-Visa system. No agreement was reported.

NATIONAL ID REQUIREMENT FOR SIM CARDS

- **National Identification Week 2026 Concludes in Mogadishu** — SONNA, 19 September 2026

  Somalia's National Identification Week closed in Mogadishu, reported on 19 September 2026. The National Identification and Registration Authority said it has registered 1.5 million citizens through 59 registration centres, 17 mobile teams and 31 centres at embassies.

NATIONAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **Somalia registers 1.5 million citizens under national ID system** — Hiiraan Online, 20 September 2026

  Somalia's identity authority has registered more than 1.5 million citizens since 2023, against a target of 15 million citizens and residents by 2029. The interior minister said issuance would extend to embassies abroad, with priority for persons with disabilities and displaced communities.

NATIONAL IDENTITY REQUIREMENT FOR DOMESTIC TRAVEL

- **Puntland passengers blocked from flights over NIRA ID requirement** — Hiiraan Online, 1 October 2026

  Somalia's federal government began enforcing a requirement on 1 October 2026 that domestic travellers carry the NIRA national identity card. Passengers at Garowe in Puntland, where the identification authority has no registration offices and the card is not issued, were refused boarding on flights to Mogadishu and Nairobi.

NATIONAL IDENTITY INTEGRATION WITH THE HALMEEL PUBLIC SERVICE CENTRE

- **Somalia Moves to Link National ID with Public Services** — Goobjoog News, 6 October 2026

  Somalia's identity authority is moving to link its registration services to HALMEEL, the national unified public service delivery centre, where an area has been set aside for it. The aim is one national identity across several government services; the integration is planned and not yet in place.

Registries

SOMALILAND CREDIT REGISTRY

- **Somaliland oo Dardargelinaysa Horumarinta iyo Hir-gelinta Nidaamka Xogta Daymaha** — Wargeyska Dawan, 12 September 2026

  The Bank of Somaliland met the country's banks and mobile money operators, including ZAAD, eDahab and KaashPlus, in Hargeisa on 11 September 2026 to plan a national credit information system. They discussed each party's role, the data required and how it will be shared, and agreed the central bank will lead the credit information bureau.

IOM AND NETHERLANDS COMPASS MIGRATION MANAGEMENT PROGRAMME

- **IOM, Somalia and Netherlands Launch Migration Management Programme** — Dawan Africa, 7 October 2026

  The International Organization for Migration, Somalia's federal government and the Netherlands launched a migration management programme on 5 October 2026 under their COMPASS partnership. It will support civil registration and legal identity in underserved areas, data-protection and information-sharing arrangements, and services for returnees and migrants. No budget or duration is given.

Sectoral management information systems

NATIONAL TRANSFORMATION PLAN DIGITAL MONITORING SYSTEM

- **Somalia Launches Digital System to Track National Transformation Plan** — Dawan Africa, 8 September 2026

  Somalia's Ministry of Planning launched a digital system on 8 September 2026 to monitor the National Transformation Plan across all 26 federal ministries, inaugurated by Deputy Prime Minister Salah Ahmed Jama. Planning Minister Mahmoud Abdirahman Beenebeene said every project will be assessed against performance indicators. The plan has so far reviewed 153 donor-funded projects.

Technology

AI

AI

SAADAAL CLIMATE EARLY-WARNING SYSTEM

- **Somalia Participates in Africa Food Systems Forum in Rwanda** — Shabelle Media Network, 5 September 2026

  A Somali government adviser, Mohamed Mukhtar Ali, told a data panel at the Africa Food Systems Forum 2026 in Kigali that Somalia's National Disaster Management Agency is building systems to give the government full ownership and control of disaster-management data. He said the agency is working with government bodies and international partners. No system, cost or timetable is named.

Inclusion

Digital divides

Digital divides

SMARTPHONE FINANCING PROGRAMME

- **Hormuud and GetPhone expand smartphone finance into four new Somali states due to high demand** — Soko Directory, 25 September 2026

  Hormuud Telecom and GetPhone said their smartphone financing programme in Somalia has sold more than 2,500 phones since its launch in May 2026 and is expanding through 15 more branches in Jubaland, South West, Hirshabelle and Galmudug. In nearly 1,700 contracts signed in August, borrowers with credit scores under 500 had repaid 89.7% of amounts due, against 90.5% for those scoring 650 or above.

Data

Open data

Open data

DATACITE NATIONAL CONSORTIUM

- **SomaliREN oo Soomaaliya ka hirgelisay dalladdii ugu horreysay ee qaran ee DataCite** — Dawan TV, 10 September 2026

  Somalia's research and education network, SomaliREN, joined DataCite and set up the country's first DataCite national consortium as its lead. Somali universities and research centres can now issue persistent identifiers (DOIs) for more than 30 types of research output, including theses, datasets and journal articles. No cost to members is given.

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